

*Lunenburg
Public Schools*

FY26 Budget

*Presented to the Lunenburg School Committee
January 22, 2025
Dr. Kate Burnham, Superintendent of Schools*

Mission

The Mission of the Lunenburg Public Schools is to provide all students with the skills, confidence, and passion for life-long learning so that they may find their own paths to successful careers, active citizenship, and rewarding lives.

Vision

The Lunenburg Public Schools is committed to becoming a leader in education by focusing on its values of attending to the personal well-being of its students, providing high-quality curricula and student-centered instruction for deeper learning at all levels, and promoting the development of attributes and skills necessary for continuous learning for all.

Strategy for Continuous Improvement

July 2018 Superintendent's Entry Plan (SY2018-2019)

November 2019 Superintendent's Report of Findings and development of the Strategy for Continuous Improvement with four objectives. (SC approved November 2019)

- To **modernize teaching and learning** by establishing effective teams of educational leaders to accomplish the essential work for transforming practice, and hiring and developing excellent educators who are continually learning and adapting practice to meet the needs of all students. (TT&L)
- To create a **culture** that values data use and continuous learning in a **climate that is safe, caring, and inclusive** and reflective of our core values. (CC&C)
- To improve **operational efficiencies**, including **communication** within the district and with the community, in order to decrease time spent on management and increase time spent on instructional leadership. (CO)
- To ensure **all students are provided equal access to a quality education**, providing them the appropriate support and challenge so that they can become skilled life-long learners. (EAAO)

March 2020 COVID Pandemic School Shutdown

FY20-24 COVID GRANTS: ESSER 1, 2, and 3 funded: teachers, counselors, tutors, stipends (Behavioral Health Coordinator), COVID supplies, and Chromebooks

FY24 Action Plans for the Strategy for Continuous Improvement focused on Cultivating Culture & Climate.

FY25 Schools received an override to fund the budget; there were six teacher positions, two counselor positions and one administrator position cut due to sunseting COVID grants.

Strategy for Continuous Improvement **FY19**

Transforming Teaching & Learning

To ensure teaching and learning are student-centered and inclusive by establishing effective teams of educational leaders to accomplish the essential work for transforming practice, and hiring and developing excellent educators who are continually learning and adapting practice to meet the needs of all students. (DSP Goals: 1, 2, 3, 5, {4,7})

Communication & Operations

To improve operational efficiencies, including communication, in order to increase the organization's capacity to execute the district's mission and vision. (DSP Goal 8)

Cultivating Climate & Culture

To create a culture that values data use and fosters continuous learning in a climate that is safe, caring, inclusive and reflective of our core values. (DSP Goals 1, 6)

Equity, Access, Opportunity & Achievement for All Students

To ensure all students are provided equal access to a high-quality education, that is collaborative, interactive, and relevant with an appropriate level of support and challenge so that they can become well-rounded, resilient, confident, and capable young adults adequately prepared for future challenges. (DSP Goals 1, 6)

Strategy for Continuous Improvement **FY23-25**

Cultivating Climate & Culture

To create a culture that values data use and fosters continuous learning in a climate that is safe, caring, inclusive and reflective of our core values.

Strategy for Continuous Improvement

In FY19

Academics

We had:

- no curriculum leadership beyond high school department heads
- no district adopted standards-aligned, rigorous on grade level curriculum in any content area K-8
- no district benchmark assessments in literacy or math
- no data to determine need for intervention
- no intervention model for academics
- no referral process for intervention
- no/limited common planning time

Behavioral Health

We had:

- no districtwide Tier 1 SEL curriculum
- one (1) social worker/adjustment counselor
- six (6) guidance counselors
- no intervention model for behavioral health
- no referral model for intervention

Strategy for Continuous Improvement

In FY25

Academics

We have:

- curriculum leadership including a Dir of Teaching & Learning, Title I Coordinator, Literacy, Math, and Co-Teaching Coaches, and high school department heads
- district adopted standards-aligned, rigorous on grade level curriculum in ELA/Literacy K-8, math K-8
- district benchmark assessments in literacy and math
- data to determine need for intervention
- intervention model for academics
- referral process for intervention
- increased common planning time

Behavioral Health

We have:

- districtwide Tier 1 SEL curriculum
- social worker/adjustment counselor in each school
- six guidance counselors
- intervention model for behavioral health
- referral model for intervention

*Data for
Context*

Enrollment & Class Size

Student Enrollment

	FY14	FY15	FY16	FY17	FY18	FY19	FY20	FY21	FY22	FY23	FY24	FY25
School/Grade	10/1/2013	10/1/2014	10/1/2015	10/1/2016	10/1/2017	10/1/2018	10/1/2019	10/1/2020	10/1/2021	10/1/2022	10/1/2023	10/1/2024
Grade 1	109	122	116	111	120	114	147	105	112	125	115	108
Grade 2	126	121	133	116	123	118	111	140	104	111	124	114
Lunenburg Primary School TOTAL	364	355	352	345	352	377	379	385	380	384	391	388
Grade 3	107	130	121	134	118	121	120	110	135	109	113	125
Grade 4	129	115	140	125	131	116	122	111	110	136	109	106
Grade 5	120	134	118	143	126	136	118	123	116	108	148	113
Turkey Hill Elementary School TOTAL	356	379	379	402	375	373	360	344	361	353	370	344
Grade 6	117	119	140	120	153	126	141	126	135	119	109	151
Grade 7	120	116	120	145	125	144	124	139	125	132	122	111
Grade 8	147	129	115	123	148	126	141	122	142	129	132	120
Lunenburg Middle School TOTAL	384	364	375	388	426	396	406	387	402	380	363	382
Grade 9	110	113	120	114	125	129	107	122	107	125	119	109
Grade 10	110	114	114	115	109	123	126	102	119	104	120	117
Grade 11	113	105	113	110	115	103	118	128	107	112	104	123
Grade 12	111	109	101	103	100	112	101	104	117	99	106	100
Lunenburg High School TOTAL	444	441	448	442	449	467	452	456	450	440	449	449
Ungraded	5	6	9	10	10	9	6	4	5	5	8	12
TOTAL (NO PRE-K)	1553	1545	1563	1587	1612	1622	1603	1576	1559	1520	1535	1524
Change	-11	-8	18	24	25	10	-19	-27	-17	-39	15	-11

2024-2025 Average Class Sizes

School	Average Class Size of Students
Lunenburg Primary School (Grades K-2)	23 (Grade K), 22 (Grade 1) 23 (Grade 2) 11-12 (PK, half day classes)
Turkey Hill Elementary School (Grades 3-5)	25 (Grade 3) 21 (Grade 4) 23 (Grade 5)
Lunenburg Middle School (Grades 6-8)	26 (Grade 6) 22 (Grade 7) 24 (Grade 8)
Lunenburg High School (Grades 9-12)	Range 5-24 Average 17 (English) Range 7-28, Average 21 (History) Range 6-24, Average 16 (Math) Range 5-24, Average 17 (Science) Range 6-24, Average 16 (World Language LHS) Range 10-31, Average 18 (Unified Arts)

Average Class Sizes PreK - 8

School	FY25	FY24	FY23
Pre-K	11-12 (Half-day classes)	11-13 (Half-day classes)	11-13(Half-day classes)
Kindergarten	23	21	21
Grade 1	22	24	20
Grade 2	23	21	22
Grade 3	25	23	23
Grade 4	21	22	24
Grade 5	23	25	22
Grade 6	26	22	21-24
Grade 7	22	20	18-23
Grade 8	24	22	22-26

Average Class Sizes LHS

LHS		FY25	FY24
English	<i>Range</i>	<i>5-24</i>	<i>3-25</i>
	<i>Average</i>	17	16
History	<i>Range</i>	<i>7-28</i>	<i>9-23</i>
	<i>Average</i>	21	18
Math	<i>Range</i>	<i>6-24</i>	<i>4-26</i>
	<i>Average</i>	16	16
Science	<i>Range</i>	<i>5-24</i>	<i>7-23</i>
	<i>Average</i>	17	17
World Language	<i>Range</i>	<i>6-24</i>	<i>7-26</i>
	<i>Average</i>	16	17
Unified Arts	<i>Range</i>	<i>10-31</i>	<i>5-27</i>
	<i>Average</i>	18	20

*Data for
Context*

**Accountability
Rating & National
Ranking**

District Accountability 2024

No accountability
data for 2020 and
2021 due to COVID

School or District	Overall Classification	Accountability Percentile	Progress Towards Targets	2023	2022	2019	2018
Lunenburg High School	Not Requiring Assistance or Intervention	63	Substantial Progress Towards Targets	63	71	68	69
Lunenburg Middle School	Not Requiring Assistance or Intervention	70	Substantial Progress Towards Targets	70	71	67	62
Turkey Hill Elementary School	Not Requiring Assistance or Intervention	53	Substantial Progress Towards Targets	51	35	33	44

US News & World Report

Lunenburg High School rankings according to US News & World Report with 18000 public schools ranked

#2736

in National Rankings

#106

in Massachusetts High Schools

#13 in Worcester, MA Metro Area High Schools

Lunenburg High US News Best Public High School rankings

Schools that rank within in the top 40% nationally are
recognized as a US News and world Report
Best High School

SCORECARD

89.62

Took at Least One AP® Exam

46%

Passed at Least One AP® Exam

38%

Mathematics Proficiency

62%

Reading Proficiency

68%

Science Proficiency

67%

Graduation Rate

96%

Nationally Best High Schools

https://www.bostonglobe.com/2023/08/30/metro/top-ranked-high-schools-in-massachusetts/?p1=HP_Feed_ContentQuery

*Data for
Context*

State Testing-
Academic
Achievement &
Growth

SPRING 2024 MCAS

Grade and Subject	Meeting or Exceeding Expectations %		Exceeding Expectations %		Meeting Expectations %		Partially Meeting Expectations %		Not Meeting Expectations %	
	District	State	District	State	District	State	District	State	District	State
GRADE 03 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	45	42	4	6	41	36	42	40	14	18
GRADE 03 - MATHEMATICS	49	44	5	10	44	35	42	35	9	20
GRADE 04 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	33	37	1	4	32	32	55	45	12	19
GRADE 04 - MATHEMATICS	46	46	6	8	40	38	48	38	7	16
GRADE 05 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	35	38	3	6	32	32	56	46	10	16
GRADE 05 - MATHEMATICS	40	40	4	6	37	34	51	46	9	14
GRADE 05 - SCIENCE AND TECH/ENG	54	45	4	7	50	37	33	36	13	20
GRADE 06 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	48	40	17	11	31	29	40	35	12	25
GRADE 06 - MATHEMATICS	51	40	7	7	44	33	43	43	6	17
GRADE 07 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	37	36	7	6	30	30	54	42	9	22
GRADE 07 - MATHEMATICS	51	37	6	8	46	30	42	44	7	19
GRADE 08 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	40	43	5	11	35	32	41	34	19	24
GRADE 08 - MATHEMATICS	40	38	3	8	37	31	52	42	8	19
GRADE 08 - SCIENCE AND TECH/ENG	50	39	10	6	40	34	41	41	9	20
GRADE 10 - ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS	67	57	15	14	52	43	30	31	3	12
GRADE 10 - MATHEMATICS	61	48	8	12	52	36	37	39	3	13
GRADE 10 - SCIENCE	63	49	6	12	57	37	32	40	4	11

- Below or at state average in meeting or exceeding expectations in **5** grade level content areas (grades 3-10)
- Above state average in meeting or exceeding expectations in **12** grade level content areas (grades 3-10)
- Only 33-67% of total students at each grade level meeting or exceeding expectations (grades 3-10)

*Data for
Context*

**National & District
Testing- Academic
Achievement &
Growth**

Local Assessment Data

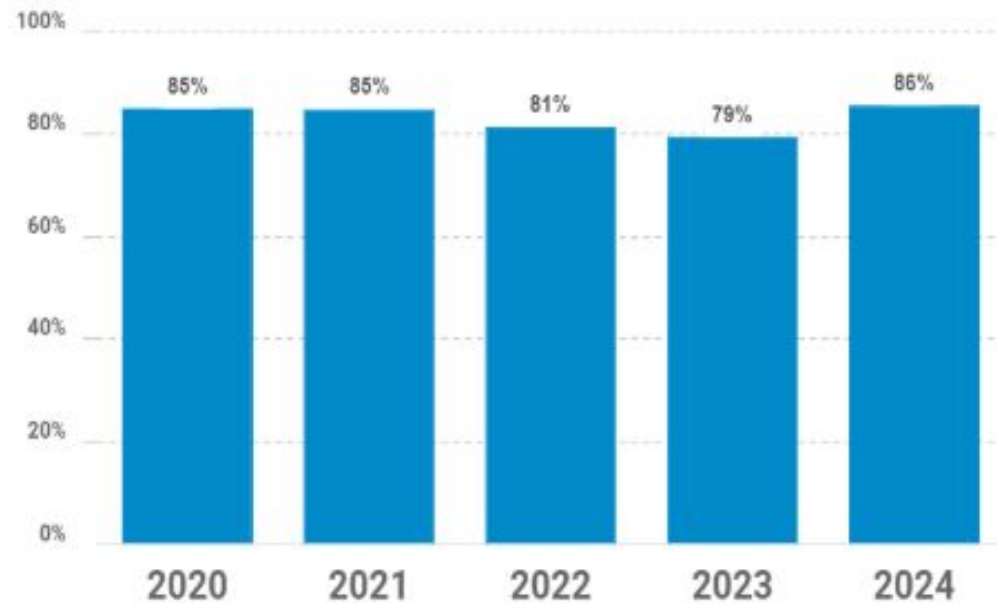
- District is currently utilizing a variety of assessments, including iReady (reading & mathematics), DIBELS, Forefront Universal Screener for Number Sense, and the HMH module assessments
- iReady reading and mathematics are administered each year in September, January and late May/June (grades 1-7); fall and spring in grades K and 8.
- Assessment reports are provided to the School Committee following each test administration; October, February, and June

AP Participation and Scores

AP Score Reports for Educators

[Reports](#)[Administrator Tools](#)[? Help](#)[Download Report](#)

% OF TOTAL AP STUDENTS WITH SCORES 3+



SCHOOL SUMMARY

	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total AP Students	80	92	75	97	83
Number of Exams	150	169	152	164	162
AP Students with Scores 3+	68	78	61	77	71
% of Total AP Students with Scores 3+	85.00	84.78	81.33	79.38	85.54

Spring 2024 iReady Data

Reading	
Grade	% on or above grade level
K	91%
1	79%
2	84%
3	82%
4	68%
5	67%
6	68%
7	63%
8	57%

Mathematics	
Grade	% on or above grade level
K	74%
1	66%
2	69%
3	76%
4	69%
5	71%
6	75%
7	66%
8	49%

*Data for
Context*

**Special Services
Data**

Special Education Data (2024-25)

Number of Students on IEPs

	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Lunenburg Primary School	67	81	73	55
Turkey Hill Elementary School	47	60	56	50
Lunenburg Middle School	66	59	63	42
Lunenburg High School	48	45	40	43
ACE Program	10	7	5	4
TOTAL	238	252	237	194

Numbers taken from SIMS End of Year Report, except FY 25 which is as of 10/22/2024

Special Education Data (2024-25)

Number of Students on IEPs & Evaluated for Special Education Services

	Students on IEPs	Pending 3 yr. re-evals.	Evaluations Completed August 26-present
Lunenburg Primary School	67	13	40
Turkey Hill Elementary School	47	6	22
Lunenburg Middle School	66	13	31
Lunenburg High School	48	5	18
ACE Program	10	1	3
TOTAL	238	38	114

*the district will evaluate at least 152 students this year to determine eligibility for special education services

Section 504 Data 2024-25

Number of Students on Section 504 Plans (as of 10/1/2024)

Location	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22
Lunenburg Primary School	7	17	17	5
Turkey Hill Elementary School	27	25	27	22
Lunenburg Middle School	31	41	55	40
Lunenburg High School	57	67	66	61
ACE Program	0	0	0	0
TOTAL	122	151	165	128

2024-2025 McKinney-Vento Data (homeless)

	FY25 <i>(as of 1/2/25)</i>	FY24	FY23
PS	1	2	3
THES		1	3
LMS			1
LHS		3	2
Totals	1	6	9

*Data for
Context*

**Behavioral
Health Data**

Behavioral Health Update & Response -Referrals

Behavioral Health Support Teams (BHST) are building-based teams established in October 2020; Members of this team review the cases of those students referred for possible intervention (Tier 2 or 3).

BHST Referrals	FY25 (up to 1/3/25)	FY24	FY23	FY22
PS	21	33	38	20
THES	37	37	68	57
LMS	20	30	72	37
LHS	31	31	31	41
Totals	109	131	209	155

Behavioral Health Curriculum: Trails to Wellness was piloted in 2021-2022 and adopted/implemented in 2022-23.

- Tier 1 SEL curriculum grades K-8 through SEL class; 9-12 through advisory
- Tier 2 CBT groups grades K-12 by social work/adjustment staff.

Behavioral Health Supports - Counselors/TIER 2 Caseloads

School	Role	FY25	FY24
Primary	School Adjustment Counselor	36	22
THES	Social Worker	12	6
	Guidance Counselor	40	61
	Social Worker & Guidance Counselor (Together)	15	6
LMS	School Adjustment Counselor	n/a	11
	Guidance Counselors	16	23
LHS	Guidance Counselors	33	2
	Social Worker	15	17
Districtwide		167 (10.6%)	148 (9%)

* Individual College and Career Readiness, Individual Counseling as Needed

Behavioral Health Supports - Counselors/TIER 3 Caseloads

School	Role	FY25	FY24
Primary	School Adjustment Counselor	14	16
THES	Social Worker	17	11
	Guidance Counselor		
	Social Worker & Guidance Counselor (Together)	0	6
LMS	School Adjustment Counselor	n/a	25
	Guidance Counselors	38	7
LHS	Guidance Counselors	8	171*
	Social Worker	23	17
Districtwide		100 (6%)	253 (16%)

* Individual College and Career Readiness, Individual Counseling as Needed

Behavioral Health Supports - Counselors Students Receiving BOTH Tier 2 & 3 Supports

School	Role	FY25	FY24
Primary	School Adjustment Counselor	9	11
THES	Social Worker	0	4
	Guidance Counselor		
	Social Worker & Guidance Counselor (Together)	0	2
LMS	School Adjustment Counselor		
	Guidance Counselors		
LHS	Guidance Counselors		
	Social Worker		
Districtwide		9 (.05%)	17 (1%)

* Individual College and Career Readiness, Individual Counseling as Needed

Behavioral Health Supports - Counselors Caseloads 2023-25

School	Role	Tier 1 23/24 - 24/25	Tier 2 23/24 - 24/25	Tier 3 23/24 - 24/25	Tier 2 / 3 (Receiving both Tier 2 & 3 support) 23/24 - 24/25
Primary	School Adjustment Counselor	398 - 387	22 - 36	16 - 14	11 - 9
THES	Social Worker		6 - 12	11- 17	4 - 0
	Guidance Counselor	370 - 345	61- 40		
	Social Worker & Guidance Counselor (Together)		6 - 15	6 - 0	2 - 0
LMS	School Adjustment Counselor (no school adjustment counselor for 24-25)		11 - n/a	25 - n/a	
	Guidance Counselors	363 - 383	23 - 16	7 - 38	
LHS	Guidance Counselors	448 - 452	2 - 33	171* - 8	
	Social Worker		17 - 15	17 - 23	
Districtwide		FY24 1579 FY25 1567	FY24 148 (9%) FY25 167 (10.6%)	FY 24 253 (16%) FY25 100 (6%)	FY24 17 (1%) FY25 9 (.05%)

Behavioral Health Supports - BCBAs

Board Certified Behavioral Analysts (BCBA) caseloads

	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21
PS	16*	44	25	23	26
THES	10*	25	21	21	23
LMS	31	23	20	13	14
LHS	26	24	24	23	21
OOD	3	3	5	6	10
TOTAL	86	119	95	86	94

*These numbers are lower due to only having a 10 hour a week contracted service BCBA for THES and The Primary School.
Can only meet IEP needs, not additional building needs.

Behavioral Health Supports - Mental Health Crisis/Hospitalizations

Section 12 totals

	FY25	FY24	FY23
LHS	0	0	0
LMS	0	0	1
THES	0	0	0
PS	0		

Hospitalizations requiring tutoring

FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21	FY20	FY19
8***	13**	16*	4	4	5	6

*(Oct-Jan 11, 2023 = 4 / Jan.12 - May 30, 2023 = 12),(**August - Dec =2, Jan - June= 11)

(***as of December 21 2024)

*Data for
Context*

Athletics Participation

LHS Athletics Programs - % Participation by Season

	FY25	FY24	FY23	FY22	FY21	FY20	FY19
Fall	44	40	47	52	COVID	38	41
Winter	43	45	45	30	18	30	31
Spring	-	52	51	50	46	COVID	41

FY26 Budget Development

FY26 Budget Priorities

Develop a budget that:

- supports School Committee prioritized programs and provides the students of Lunenburg with the best possible educational opportunities with attention to:
 - differentiated instruction,
 - equity,
 - family engagement; and
 - aligns with the priorities of the Strategy for Continuous Improvement
-

FY25 School Department Budget Process

August

District Leadership Team participated in data summits; reviewed the Strategy for Continuous Improvement; revised Strategy Priority Action Plans; aligned School Improvement Plan goals and administrator/teacher evaluation goals to the Strategy Priority Action Plans.

October/November

Department heads and building principals began working on budgets which were submitted to the Director of Finance & Administration in November.

December/January

Central Office Leadership began meeting with building administration and department heads to discuss the impact of a projected 12% increase to health insurance, coupled with CBA and contractual service increases, on the FY26 budget. Each expense line was scrutinized to ensure that every necessary expense was accounted for. Discussions began regarding potential personnel cuts pending the Interim Town Manager's target budget. A level services budget was presented on January 22, 2025.

February

The proposed budget will be adjusted when the actual health insurance percentage is known. There will be Budget Q&A session at the first School Committee meeting in February.

March

The Superintendent will present a recommended budget. There will be Budget Q&A session at the first School Committee meeting in March. The School Committee will hold a budget hearing and approve a budget; and the school department budget will be presented to the Finance Committee (March 6, 2025).

Positions lost in FY25

Positions Lost in FY25

Positions CUT in the FY25 budget due to loss of ESSER

Instructional Coach (district)
Intervention Teacher (LHS)
Classroom Teacher (LMS-*grade 8*)
Classroom Teacher (LHS-*history*)
Guidance Counselor (LMS)
Guidance Counselor (LMS/LHS)
Classroom Teacher (THES-*grade 5*)
Wilson Reading Teacher (THES)
Social Worker (PS-*second SW position*)
PE Teacher (PS/THES)

FY26 School Department Budget Summary

	FY25 Budget	FY26 Proposed	Increase
Personnel	\$17,407,138	18,910,021	8.63%
Non-Personnel	\$7,700,344	9,797,227	27.23%
TOTAL	\$24,851,494 <u>+\$31,882</u> \$24,883,376	28,707,248	14.34%

FY26 School Department Budget Summary

Budget includes:

- CBA increases: step increases, longevity & degree advancements
- Health insurance: 12% increase
- Transportation
 - General (7.6%)
 - Special Education (27%)
 - Athletics (254%)

FY26 School Department Budget Summary

Budget includes:

- Out-of-district tuition increases at projected 3.42% increase
- Utility cost increases
- All stipends in the LEA CBA
- All coaches
- Website hosting

FY26 School Department Budget Summary

Additional factors impacting the budget:

There is a salary reserve budgeted for these pending negotiations with the following groups:

Bargaining Unit Contracts:

Lunenburg Paraprofessional Union

Non-bargaining Unit Contracts:

Multiple employee contracts are up for contract renewal starting on July 1, 2025
~including the Superintendent and Facility Director

FY26 School Department Budget Summary

Factors requiring the department to estimate line items:

- **Chapter 70 Funding:**

State FY26 Budget has not been set

- **Circuit Breaker:**

Amount will not be released until end of FY25; expecting a value to cover 75% of costs as well as a possible increase for Out of District (OOD) transportation.

- **Federal & State Grants:**

Allocations are typically not announced for entitlement grants until late July/early August; the district is anticipating level funding.

FY26 School Department Budget Summary

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Questions?